

Employment First Resource List

Revised November 2011

General Information

1. APSE PUBLICATIONS

- a. **APSE Employment First Statement:** Statement outlining principles of Employment First - www.apse.org/docs/APSE%20Employment%20First%20Statement%20-%20FINAL-1.pdf
- b. **APSE Employment First White Paper:** “Establishing a National Employment First Agenda” paper from APSE - www.apse.org/docs/Employment%20First%20Paper%20609%5B1%5D.pdf
- c. **APSE Connections-Employment First:** Article from JTPR APSE Connections advocating a national Employment First agenda

2. **Alliance for Full Participation:** The Alliance for Full Participation (AFP) site contains a number of Employment First documents and updates from various states on their Employment First activities - www.allianceforfullparticipation.org

3. **Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities Article – *Employment First: A Beginning Not an End*:** August 2011 Intellectual and Developmental Disabilities journal article summarizing the principles of Employment First - <http://www.aiddjournals.org/doi/abs/10.1352/1934-9556-49.4.300>

4. **NASDDDS Article – *Workers First*:** Article from June 2009 Community Services Reporter, published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services providing an overview of Employment First efforts - [www.nasddds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst\(Moseley\).pdf](http://www.nasddds.org/pdf/WorkersFirst(Moseley).pdf)

5. **NTAR Leadership Center Blog:** Blog post on Employment First by Wendy Parent, Kansas University - <http://ntarseedingchange.blogspot.com/2010/03/employment-first.html>

6. **ODEP-USDOL Employment First Memo:** January 2009 memo from the US Department of Labor Office of Disability Employment Policy stressing importance of Employment First - www.dol.gov/odep/events/employmentfirst/employmentfirst.htm

7. SELN PUBLICATIONS

- a. **SELN Employment First Publication:** “Q & A’s on State Employment First Policies”: publication from the State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) providing an overview of Employment First, and specific efforts in Colorado, Florida, Oklahoma, Pennsylvania, Tennessee, Washington State, Georgia, Minnesota, and Indiana - http://selnmembers.org/images/stories/site_documents/dmr%20request%20employment%20policy%203-08rev.pdf
- b. **SELN Maintaining Focus:** Article from March 2009 Community Services Reporter, published by National Association of State Directors of Developmental Disabilities Services “Maintaining a Focus on Employment in Tough Economic Times” – intended to encourage state systems to maintain focus on employment despite current economic conditions - www.nasddds.org/pdf/MaintainingFocusOnEmployment.pdf

State Specific Information

1. **ARKANSAS** – Governor’s Executive Order: Executive order establishing the Arkansas Employment First Initiative - www.arkdisabilityrights.org/doc/eo_1017.pdf
2. **CALIFORNIA**
 - a. **CA Employment First Legislation Overview:** Overview of AB 287 from California State Council on Developmental Disabilities - www.scdd.ca.gov/Legislation/AB287/Learnabout-AB287_9-09combined.pdf
 - b. **CA Legislation (passed):** Text of AB 287, California’s Legislation on Employment First, signed into law in October 2009 - www.leginfo.ca.gov/pub/09-10/bill/asm/ab_0251-0300/ab_287_bill_20091011_chaptered.pdf
3. **CONNECTICUT - DDS Newsletter:** Connecticut Department of Developmental Services self-determination newsletter discussing state’s Employment First efforts - www.ct.gov/dds/lib/dds/self_determination/newsletters/sd_newsletter_june_2008.pdf
4. **DELAWARE**
 - a. **Delaware Employment First Statement:** Statement from Delaware Division of Developmental Disabilities Services on Employment First - www.dhss.delaware.gov/ddds/emp_first.html
 - b. **Delaware DDDS Newsletter:** Newsletter from Delaware DDDS with further details on Employment First - www.dhss.delaware.gov/ddds/files/learn_curve_june09.pdf
5. **FLORIDA Developmental Disabilities Council Employment First Statement:** Statement from Florida DD Council in support of Employment First - <http://www.fddc.org/about/employment>
6. **GEORGIA – Employment First Georgia Website** - www.employmentfirstgeorgia.org
7. **INDIANA**
 - a. **IN APSE Employment First 2009 follow-up:** Summary of follow-up items from 2005 Indiana Employment First Summit - www.inapse.org/styles/inapse/defiles/summit%20update%2012-15-09.pdf
 - B. **IN Employment First Fact Sheet:** Fact sheet summarizing 2005 Indiana Employment First Summit - www.apse.org/docs/IN_APSE_empl_first_fact_sheet.pdf
8. **IOWA**
 - a. **Iowa’s Employment First Initiative: A Call for Change of Historical Proportion:** Fall 2009 white paper outlining vision for an Employment First initiative in Iowa - www.allianceforfullparticipation.org/component/content/article/196-iowas-employment-first-initiative
 - b. **Iowa Employment First Initiative Summary Points:** One-page summary of rationale for Employment First in Iowa
9. **KANSAS**
 - a. **Kansas Employment First Legislation (passed):** Text of Kansas House Bill 2336 that establishes a statewide policy of employment first for all people with disabilities. Bill was signed into law in May 2011. - www.kslegislature.org/li/b2011_12/year1/measures/documents/hb2336_enrolled.pdf

- b. **Kansas Employment First Summary:** Summary of Kansas Employment First efforts and link to materials - www.workinghealthy.org/employmentfirst.html
 - c. **Kansas Employment First Flyer:** Flyer promoting Employment First in Kansas - www.workinghealthy.org/downloads/EmploymentFirstFlyer.pdf
 - d. **Kansas Report – Employment First Workgroup:** May 2009 from Employment First Initiative Work Group - www.apse.org/docs/aaaemployment_first_work_group_initial_report.pdf
 - e. **Kansas Executive Orders:** Executive orders from the Governor of Kansas issued 8/26/10, related to employment of individuals in the community
- 10. LOUISIANA** – Employment First policy statement from the Louisiana Office of Citizens with Developmental Disabilities - http://new.dhh.louisiana.gov/assets/docs/OCDD/Other/Employment_First_MEMO.pdf
- 11. MARYLAND**
- a. **Development Disabilities Administration Position Statement on Employment Services** - http://dhh.maryland.gov/dda_md/Training/DDA91809.pdf
 - b. **Employment First Overview: Overview of Maryland’s Development Disabilities Administration Employment First initiative** - www.reinventingquality.org/docs/ColleenGauruder-08.pdf
- 12. MASSACHUSETTS**
- a. **MA Employment First Policy:** 2010 policy issuance from Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services
 - b. **MA DDS RFQ:** Excerpts from 2009 Massachusetts Department of Developmental Disability Services service provider solicitation, highlighting a shift in Massachusetts to an Employment First Policy
- 13. MICHIGAN Employment Works! Policy:** Policy from Michigan Department of Community Health, indicating that all individuals will be supported to pursue competitive work. Applies to individuals with mental illness and developmental disabilities.
- 14. MINNESOTA**
- a. **MN Employment First Summit Report I: Report of 2007 MN Employment First Summit** - A Manifesto on the Employment of Minnesotans with Disabilities in the Integrated, Competitive Workforce - www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report.pdf
 - b. **MN Employment First Summit Report II: Report of 2008 MN Employment First Summit** - A Progress Report on Employment First Performance in Minnesota - www.mnapse.org/Employment-First-Report-Summit-2.pdf
 - c. **Minnesota Employment First Web Links:**
 - **Minnesota Employment Policy Initiative Website:** www.mn-epi.org/main
 - **Minnesota Employment Training & Technical Assistance Website:** www.mntat.org/main
 - **Minnesota Employment First Blogs:** <http://employment1st.blogspot.com>
www.mn-epi.blogspot.com
- 15. MISSOURI:** January 2011 Employment First Policy, issued by the Missouri Department of Mental Health, Division of Developmental Disabilities – www.dmh.mo.gov/docs/dd/employmentpolicyfinal.doc

16. NEW MEXICO Webinar: “Making Employment First a Reality in NM” webinar and text - www.health.state.nm.us/DDSD/meaningfullife/EmployFirstRsres.htm

17. NEW YORK

- a. **State Office for People with Development Disabilities (OPWDD) Center for Employment Excellence Website** - www.opwdd.ny.gov/cee/index.jsp
- b. **OPWDD 2011 Interim Report on State Plan** – February 2011 interim report on 2010-2014 OPWDD Statewide Comprehensive Plan, that includes summary of efforts on Employment First (pp. 6-7) - www.opwdd.ny.gov/507plan/images/Interim_5_07_Rpt_Final_2_15.pdf
- c. **OMRDD 2010 Interim Report on State Plan** – February 2010 interim report on 2009-2013 OMRDD Statewide Comprehensive, that includes summary of efforts on Employment First (p. 5) - www.opwdd.ny.gov/507plan/images/OMR_Interim_Report_2_10_Final.pdf

18. NORTH CAROLINA APSE Article: Article from North Carolina APSE calling for an Employment First Policy - www.ncapse.org/WhitePaperEmploymentFirst.pdf

19. NORTH DAKOTA Employment First Summit Report: October 2011 report summarizing the findings and plan of action resulting from the state’s Employment First summit in October 2010 - <http://www.independencecil.org/News.aspx?ID=22>

20. OKLAHOMA DDS Employment Policy: Oklahoma Developmental Disabilities Services employment policy, stating that the optimal goal of waiver services is full-time employment in the community - www.okdhs.org/library/policy/oac317/040/07/0001000.htm

21. OREGON

- a. **Oregon DDS Employment First Initiative:** Includes information on Oregon’s Employment First Initiative with link to Oregon Office of Developmental Disability Services Policy on employment for working age individuals - www.dhs.state.or.us/dd/supp_emp/initiative.html
- b. **Article on Employment First:** Opinion piece published in Oregon newspapers - <http://theportlander.com/2010/03/16/employment-first-for-all-oregonians>
- c. **Oregon Employment First Plan:** Plan developed for implementation of Employment First in Oregon - https://www.sidestreetshop.com/stores/195/libraries/articulate/wise_or_ef_recommendations_page_r_1_28_2011_final_w_o_copyright_notice_1.pdf

22. PENNSYLVANIA

- a. **PA Employment Legislation:** State legislation that mandates access to community employment - www.pacode.com/secure/data/055/chapter6000/subchapKtoc.html
- b. **PA Employment Policy - General:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation on community employment as a priority - www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/misc/00-05-07.pdf
- c. **PA Employment Policy – ICFs/MR:** 2005 policy document from Pennsylvania Department of Public welfare on supporting community employment for individuals living in Intermediate Care Facilities for Individuals with Mental Retardation, indicating community employment as a priority without regard to level of disability - www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/icf/00-06-08.pdf
- d. **PA Employment Policy – 1990:** 1990 policy document from Pennsylvania Office of Mental Retardation directing that community employment be considered as a service option before less

integrated, more restricted options -

www.temple.edu/thetrainingpartnership/resources/mrBulletins/misc/6000-90-06.pdf

23. RHODE ISLAND

- a. **Employment First Summit Report** - Report of Employment First Summit held in March 2010 - www.rhodesoindependence.org/docs/final%20summary%20report.pdf
- b. **Employment First Policy White Paper** – Paper discussing options for Employment First legislation in Rhode Island - www.rhodesoindependence.org/docs/Policy%20White%20Paper%20-%20Final%20%20-%202011.23.10.pdf
- c. **1115 Waiver Group Report** – September 2009 paper which contains initial proposal for Rhode Island to be an Employment First state - www.ohhs.ri.gov/documents/documents09/Employmt_Wkgp_recs.pdf

24. TENNESSEE

- a. **ARC of TN Statement** – Statement from ARC of Tennessee in support of Employment First - www.thearctn.org/Employment.php
- b. **TN DMRS Employment First Statement:** 2003 statement of support from the Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services in support of Tennessee’s Employment First! Initiative - www.onestops.info/resources/TN_CEP/Employment_First_Final.doc
- c. **TN DMRS Newsletter 07:** 2007 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services newsletter containing article on employment first – pp. 3-5 - http://tennessee.gov/dids/newsroom/publications/personally_speaking/march_07.pdf
- d. **TN DMRS Provider Manual Excerpt:** Excerpt from 2005 Tennessee Division of Mental Retardation Services provider manual regarding Employment First, and requirements for vocational evaluation (situational assessment) every three years. To find this excerpt, go to the full manual and search for “Employment First” – www.state.tn.us/dids/provider_agencies/Provider%20Manual.pdf
- e. **TN Employment First Overview:** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Tennessee’s Employment First policy - www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=202

25. TEXAS – Legislation (proposed): Text of Texas House Bill 785 requiring that employment services be structured to ensure employment of people with disabilities in integrated settings. Current status (7/11) is that bill has not been acted on. - www.statesurge.com/bills/hb-785-texas-452277

26. UTAH – Legislation (passed): Text of Utah House Bill, that requires that employment be the first priority for individuals with disabilities receiving publicly funded supports. Bill was signed into law in March 2011. - <http://le.utah.gov/~2011/bills/hbillamd/hb0240.htm>

27. VIRGINIA – Legislation (proposed): Text of Virginia House Bill HJ 633 to develop an Employment First Initiative - <http://lis.virginia.gov/cgi-bin/legp604.exe?111+ful+HJ633+pdf>

28. WASHINGTON STATE

- a. **ICI Pub-Washington WAAP:** Publication from the Institute for Community Inclusion providing an overview of Washington's Working Age Adult Policy - www.communityinclusion.org/article.php?article_id=222
- b. **Washington State Policy:** Washington Division of Developmental Disabilities Working Age Adult Policy - www.dshs.wa.gov/pdf/adsa/ddd/policies/policy4.11.pdf

29. WISCONSIN

- a. **WI Employment First Flyer:** Wisconsin APSE Employment First flyer
- b. **WI Employment First Plan 2010:** Wisconsin Employment First plan developed in 2010
- c. **WI Employment First Rationale-FAQ:** Wisconsin APSE rationale and frequently asked questions regarding Employment First - www.wiapse.org/WI%20Employment%20First%20Initiative%20Rationale.doc
- d. **WI Mission and Values Statement:** Wisconsin Employment First Mission and Values Statement, asking individuals to commit to Employment First
- e. **Employment First Wisconsin Booklet:** Report from Employment First Wisconsin - <http://www.wiapse.org/documents%20folder/EmploymentFirstBooklet.pdf>

International Efforts

Australia – Website of Employment First Australia

<http://employmentfirst.org.au>

Developed by David Hoff, Institute for Community Inclusion, UMass Boston

Copies of items that are not available on the worldwide web can be obtained by sending an email to david.hoff@umb.edu; phone: 617-287-4308



www.seln.org

SELN Working Document

The State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) is a cross-state cooperative venture of state MR/DD agencies that are committed to improving employment outcomes for adolescents and adults with developmental disabilities. Working documents contain information collected in response to state requests, and federal, state and local initiatives of interest to the SELN membership. They are intended to share work in progress but may not be a comprehensive analysis or compilation. Working documents are updated over time as information changes.

